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FINAL POLICE RACISM HEARING CHARGED WITH EMOTION



ERNEST L. BROWN, father of 28-year-old Roland Brown who was killed by a White Oakland policeman on March 24, tells of his frustration and anger at final police racism hearing last Monday before crowd of some 200 at Bethlehem Lutheran Church in West Oakland.

(Oakland, Calif.) - The third and final scheduled public hearing on Oakland police racism held last Monday evening at Bethlehem Lutheran Church in West Oakland demonstrated again the deep concern of the community and the validity of charges of police racism made by the Community Coalition on Police Racism, the Black Oakland Police Officers Association and numerous Oakland residents, Black and White.

Last Monday's hearing before some 200 persons was highlighted by the appearance of Ernest L. Brown, Sr., father of Ronald Brown, 28, killed in broad daylight by a White Oakland policeman on March 24. Mrs. Ernest Brown testified before the first public hearing on April 21 at Allen Temple Baptist Church. Her moving statement was published in full in THE BLACK PANTHER of April 28, 1975.

Mr. Ernest Brown set a somber and angry tone before a hushed audience at Bethlehem Lutheran Church declaring: "I can't keep on being dutiful to people like Mr. Rose (chairman of the City Council committee investigating police racism), or anybody else in his position. I can't keep on being dutiful to the police department or to our elected officials.

"I can only pray that I don't make the mistake that the police department did to my son. I have to pray and pray long that I do not
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